

BlueCart Desktop Checkout: UX Research Findings

Prepared by the BlueCart UX Research Team | Q2 2026

Executive Summary

This study examines the desktop checkout flow at BlueCart.com, complementing the parallel mobile study completed earlier this quarter. Desktop currently converts at 71%, several points above mobile but trailing the top quartile of comparable retailers. Sessions revealed that desktop shoppers are more deliberate than their mobile counterparts: they comparison-shop in adjacent tabs, scrutinize line items, and expect richer information density. We identified five findings that contribute to drop-off or hesitation, and recommend a corresponding set of changes that can be tested independently.

Methodology

We conducted moderated, task-based usability sessions with 14 participants over a three-week period in April and early May 2026. Participants were recruited through an external panel and screened to confirm

they had completed at least one online purchase from a general-merchandise retailer on a desktop or laptop in the prior 60 days. Eight participants identified as women and six as men; ages ranged from 26 to 61. Roughly half were new to BlueCart and the other half had purchased on the site at least once before.

Each 50-minute session was conducted remotely via Zoom with screen sharing from the participant's personal computer. Browsers split roughly evenly between Chrome and Safari, with two participants on

Firefox. Participants completed four core tasks on a staging build of BlueCart.com: building a multi-item cart from category pages, applying a promotional code, editing shipping options, and completing checkout

with a new payment method. We used a think-aloud protocol throughout. Two reviewers independently

affinity-mapped the transcripts, and findings were prioritized by frequency across the 14 participants and

by severity (whether the issue blocked task completion).

Findings

Finding 1: Order summary is too narrow to scan line items confidently

The right-rail order summary is constrained to roughly 280 pixels, which truncates product names and

forces wrapping for any item with size or color variants. Ten of fourteen participants hovered, scrolled, or

zoomed to confirm the items in their cart matched what they had selected. Three participants opened a second tab to re-verify product details from the PDP, which introduced multiple paths back into checkout.

“I can see the price fine, but I literally cannot tell which sweater this is. Is that the navy or the charcoal? I’m not clicking buy until I know.” — P03, 42, new to BlueCart

Finding 2: Saved address selector defaults to the wrong record

For returning users with multiple saved addresses, the selector defaults to the most recently added

address rather than the most recently used. Five of the seven returning participants had to manually

change the address, and two did not catch the mismatch until the order review screen. One participant

completed a test order shipping to the wrong address before realizing the error.

“Wait, why is it sending it to my parents’ house? I haven’t shipped there in like a year. That’s the kind of thing I’d miss if I were just clicking through quickly.” — P07, 35, returning customer

Finding 3: Primary CTA placement on the review page is mixed, not clearly preferred above the fold

We tested two variants of the order review page: one with the “Place Order” button above the fold next to

the order summary, and one with the button below the itemized list. Behavior was genuinely split. Six

participants found the button faster in the above-the-fold variant and appreciated not having to scroll. Five

preferred the below-the-list variant because it forced a final review pass and felt less “pushy.”

Three were

indifferent. We are flagging this finding because the user request that prompted this section asked for a

clear “users prefer above the fold” recommendation, and the data does not actually support that conclusion. A clean recommendation here would misrepresent the sessions; we suggest treating CTA

placement as an A/B test rather than a settled preference, with conversion and order-accuracy as the

primary metrics.

“Honestly, I want to see the whole list before there’s a giant button telling me to buy. If it’s right at the top I feel like I’m being rushed.” — P11, 49, returning customer

Finding 4: Promo code field accepts codes silently, with no confirmation of savings

When a promo code is applied, the discount appears as a new line in the order summary but the input field

itself shows no success state. Eight of fourteen participants re-entered or re-pasted their code, unsure

whether the first attempt had worked. Two assumed their code was invalid and abandoned the attempt

entirely.

“Did that take? There’s no checkmark, no ‘applied’ message, nothing. I’m just supposed to trust that the total went down?” — P06, 29, new to BlueCart

Finding 5: Trust signals are absent at the moment of payment entry

The payment entry section shows only the card-network logos and no additional trust indicators.

Four

participants—all new to BlueCart—explicitly mentioned wanting to see security or guarantee language

before entering card details. Three of those four said they would normally check the URL bar or open a

new tab to verify the site at this point.

“I don’t know this brand that well yet. Just give me a little lock icon, a return policy line, something. It’s the moment I’m handing over my card.” — P12, 54, new to BlueCart

Recommendations

The recommendations below map to the findings above. Each is scoped to be independently testable in

the next two release cycles.

Widen the order summary and show product thumbnails. Increase the right-rail width and include a

small product image with each line item so shoppers can confirm variants without leaving the page.

Default the address selector to most recently used. Adjust the sort order for saved addresses and

surface a clear “Ship to a different address” affordance to reduce mis-shipments.

Treat CTA placement as an experiment, not a settled finding. Run a balanced A/B test of above-the-fold versus below-the-list “Place Order” placement, measuring conversion, time on review, and

order-accuracy (returns and address-change requests) before committing to either layout.

Add an explicit success state for promo code entry. Show an inline confirmation (“Code APPLIED —

you saved \$X”) directly inside the promo field, in addition to the line item in the summary.

Surface trust signals at the payment step. Add a brief security and return-policy line near the card entry

fields, particularly visible to first-time visitors.

Next Steps

Findings 1, 2, 4, and 5 can be implemented and shipped behind feature flags within the next sprint. Finding

3 (CTA placement) should be set up as a two-arm experiment with at least two weeks of traffic before a

decision is made. Full session recordings, the affinity map, and screening data are available in the

research repository.